

Rugby Intelligent Camera

*Note: Sub-titles are not captured in Xplore and should not be used

Canto da Silva Delatorre, Tiago
Electrical and informatics department
INSA Toulouse
Toulouse, France
tcanto-da-si@insa-toulouse.fr

Visbal Pinzon, Kevin Felipe
Electrical and informatics department
INSA Toulouse
Toulouse, France
kvisbal-pinz@insa-toulouse.fr

Given Name Surname
dept. name of organization (of Aff.)
name of organization (of Aff.)
City, Country
email address or ORCID

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dept. name of organization (of Aff.)
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Abstract—Camera-based tracking systems are increasingly used in sports to enhance performance analysis and broadcast production. However, existing solutions are typically expensive and complex, making them inaccessible for amateur clubs with limited resources. This project aims to develop a cost-effective and functional camera tracking solution to, in real time, broadcast and capture the statistics of an amateur rugby match. Our proposition relies on a multi-camera setup which is controlled by a trained computer vision model, YOLO (You Only Look Once).

Index Terms—computer vision, rugby, cost-effective, camera tracking, YOLO

I. INTRODUCTION

This document is a model and instructions for L^AT_EX. Please observe the conference page limits.

II. TECHNICAL CHOISES (EXPLANING HOW WE APPROCHED THE PROBLEM)

A. Maintaining the Integrity of the Specifications

The IEEEtran class file is used to format your paper and style the text. All margins,

III. OUR WORK

We can change the order of the project aswell

Identify applicable funding agency here. If none, delete this.

A. YOLO Model

A model of Artificial Intelligence is a trained code to learn patterns based on a database[citar qualquer coisa que defina um modelo]. In between the existent models, there is the model YOLO whose algorithm treats the image only one time (You Only Look Once).

Models like YOLO have faster responses to the video's processing, so they are usually used for real time processing, autonomus cars, monitoring, etc. The detection of plany of objects at the same time is also a caracteristic of these models, but the main reason we chose YOLO as our model was to process efficiently and with high speed.

To be able to use YOLO in python, we used the library Ultralytics[citaaaaar] which makes simpler the utilisation of pre-trained models, image detection and others uses of computer vision. As so, the Figure 1 [3] compares the diferentes versions of YOLO's models by latency and precision of detection. Therefore, considering the speed as main goal to track in real time during a rugby match, we chose to work with YOLOv8 version.

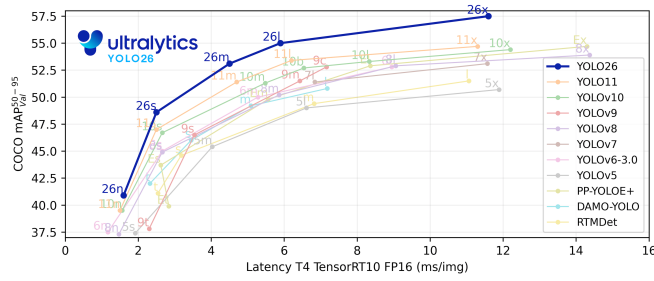


Fig. 1. Comparaison des modèles YOLO supportés par Ultralytics. Source : Ultralytics [3]

Nevertheless, the Ultralytics website also presents the performance metrics of different models of the chosen version as shown at the Figure 2 [3]. To the image processing, tests were made to choose the one with good balance between accuracy and processing time.

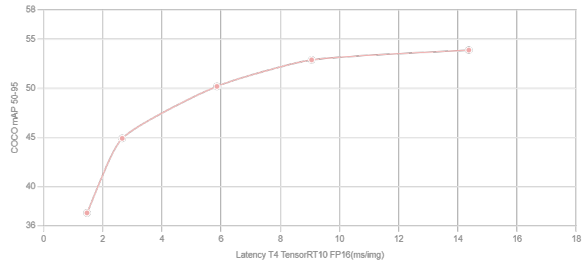


Fig. 2. Courbe de performance des différentes variantes du modèle YOLOv8. Source : Ultralytics [3]

The version of the chosen model was decided by made using one frame taken from a video recorded in the real situation of a amateur match, the goal of this article, in each of the models offered by Ultralytics. The Table I, shows the results obtained in terms of processing time and quality of detection.

TABLE I
COMPARISON OF YOLOv8 MODEL VARIANTS IN THE SAME FRAME.

Model	Detected Objects	Inference	Total Time	FPS
YOLOv8n	15 persons	61.8 ms	66.0 ms	15.15
YOLOv8s	18 persons	137.5 ms	140.8 ms	7.10
YOLOv8m	21 persons	206.2 ms	208.8 ms	4.79
YOLOv8l	22 persons	616.8 ms	621.5 ms	1.61
YOLOv8x	22 persons	653.5 ms	657.2 ms	1.52

Based on these results and aiming for fast processing, we chose YOLOv8n because, even though it does not recognize as many players as the more robust models, it is more than ten times faster.

Another important conclusion is that increasing the size of the YOLOv8 model does not necessarily lead to a proportional improvement in detection performance like YOLOv8x which does not perform more efficiently on the image than YOLOv8l, even though it requires more processing time.

Although the larger models detect more players, their processing time increases significantly, which makes them less suitable for real-time video analysis.

1) *Methods:* To track the focus of a rugby match, we agreed that the most important thing we should track is the ball, but in rugby the ball is small and always hidden between the players or very close to their chest, causing a big problem for the model's identification of the ball. In order to solve this problem, we added the class player; this implies that the players will also be identified by the model.

In rugby, the teams usually place themselves in lines of attack and defense, so, normally the point of interest will take place where the greatest number of players are. With both classes, we can already create a working tracking model.

The world of computer vision developers is growing and one of the biggest communities is the Roboflow Universe, which we can find a great number of models and datasets. The project Rugby Detection Computer Vision Model [1] was the closest to our project's needs, and the pictures used in this dataset are similar to the images we captured in an INSA AS match.

2) *Results:* After testing the model from the project [1] in some images from the captured match (Fig. 3 to Fig. 5), positive results were achieved: the model responds well to the images, identifying a big number of player and the ball. Some problems were: confusing the arbitrator with a player, not identifying all the players, and sometimes not seeing the ball.



Fig. 3. Test image 1, used model from Roboflow [1].

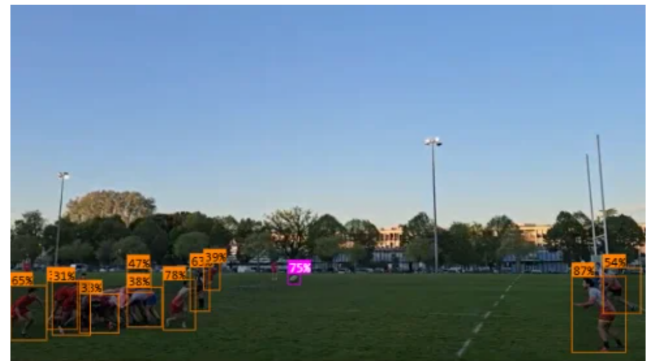


Fig. 4. Test image 2, used model from Roboflow [1].

Unfortunately, the model [1] isn't accessible to download, so it wouldn't be possible to use in a real time application,



Fig. 5. Test image 3, used model from Roboflow [1].

because for every frame the Roboflow repository would have to be accessed on the internet, increasing the cost and delay of the image processing.

To solve the presented problem, the project's dataset [1] was cloned and a new AI model was trained, hoping to achieve the same results as the previous. Four models were created, two with yolov8n, one with yolov8s and the last with yolov8m; they were all tested in an image not from the dataset.



Fig. 6. Test image 1, used trained yolov8n model.



Fig. 7. Test image 2, used trained yolov8n model.

These models aren't as good as the previous one because they don't have the same accuracy and have a greater difficulty

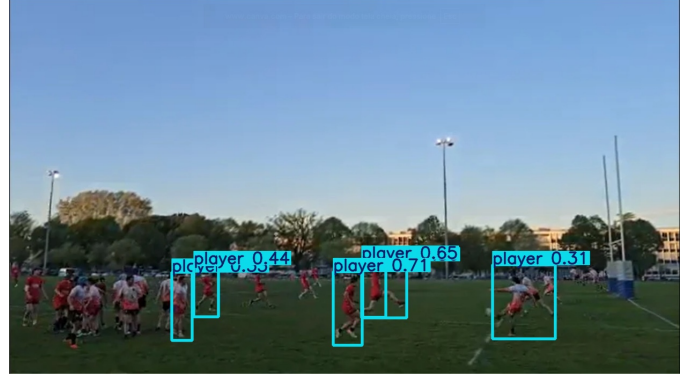


Fig. 8. Test image 3, used trained yolov8n model.

of identifying the wanted features, as seen in Fig. 6 to Fig. 8. At least they are functional for video analyses and can be used for real-time applications.

To validate our models, we tested it in a video of an INSA AS match, but the power of the available GPU wasn't enough to analyze a nineteen second video (with 1141 frames). So, we couldn't validate our models in a hole video but, analyzing in a smaller video, we can see some problems of players and ball identification, showing how the project would look like in a real-time solution.

3) *Conclusion:* Regarding the YOLO model we can conclude that this solution works for identification of our needs to choose the best camera but, trying to find a low-cost solution for the amateur clubs we arrived at a lack of computing power that probably will increase the cost of this approach, the best identification models may compromise the real-time response.

4) *Improvements:* To improve this project, we plan on using another YOLO model [2] to see the statistics of the game as well, identifying tackle, penalty kick, throw-in, scrum, and other similar rugby situations that our other model can't identify. Another aimed improvement is to create a system [2] so the model could be able to after identifying the players, separate them between team A and team B. The system consists of a Sigmoid loss language image pre-trained [2] (extract color information from the player's shirt), associated with an UMAP [2] (compact the previous information) and a Kmeans [2] (sort both teams). These improvements would highly increase the quality of the performance analysis of the teams.

B. Video Acquisition and Transmission Architecture

Real-time automated tracking of amateur rugby players imposes strict constraints regarding bandwidth, latency, and hardware costs. This section details the technological choices made to ensure a fluid and synchronized video stream to the central processing unit.

C. Capture Device Choice

Several capture solutions were evaluated to meet the requirements of the multi-camera tracking project. The use of cameras on motorized platforms was initially considered for

its dynamic tracking capability—which could have reduced the number of cameras needed and thus the total cost. However, extreme sensitivity to control delays and prohibitive costs led to its rejection. Similarly, solutions based on microcontrollers such as Arduino, while inexpensive, offered insufficient acquisition performance and resolution for exploitation via YOLOv8 detection models.

Ultimately, smartphones were selected as the capture units. These devices offer an optimal compromise: label=•

- **Image Quality** : High-resolution sensors capable of providing stable streams.
- **Cost** : Utilization of existing hardware, drastically reducing the initial investment.
- **Wireless Capability** :

D. Evaluation of Streaming Protocols

To route the video streams from the smartphones to the processing computer, three main protocols were compared:

Protocol	Infra-structure	Latency	Stability / Cost
SRT	4G / 5G	Low	Excellent; high subscription costs
RTMP	4G/5G + remote server	Medium	Industry standard (Youtube, Twitch); requires a server
HTTP (Local)	Wi-Fi (router)	Optimal	Excellent stability; no recurring cost

The **HTTP protocol over a local network** was selected. Unlike cellular solutions (SRT/RTMP) that depend on public network load and incur data costs, the local network allows full control, high stability, and minimizes latency.

E. Local Network Implementation and Topology

The network architecture put in place relies on the creation of a **high-performance private Wi-Fi network** (using a HUAWEI WiFi AX3-type router). This configuration makes it possible to avoid potential interference with the public networks of stadiums.

The system is structured as follows:

- 1) **Wireless transmission**: The four smartphones transmit their respective streams to the central access point via the HTTP protocol. Tests in real conditions validated an effective range of **80 metres**, covering a significant portion of the playing surface.
- 2) **Downstream link**: The router is connected to the processing computer (YOLOv8 computing unit) via a gigabit Ethernet connection. This wired link ensures that the bottleneck does not occur at the final data reception stage.
- 3) **Centralised processing**: The computer simultaneously receives the four streams to perform player detection and tracking.

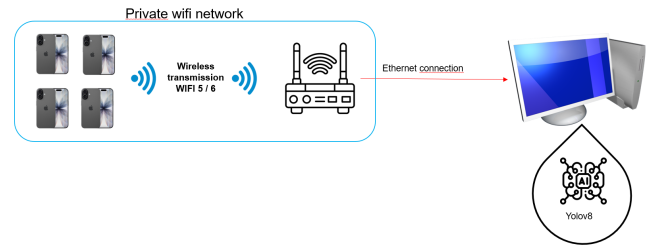


Fig. 9. Network topology: four smartphones transmit wirelessly via HTTP (80 m range) to a private Wi-Fi router, which forwards data via gigabit Ethernet to the YOLOv8 processing computer.

F. Camera score algorithm

Please use “soft” (e.g., $\text{eqref}\{Eq\}$) cross references instead

G. IHM

- The word “data” is plural, not singular.

An excellent style manual for science writers is [?].

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The preferred spelling of the word “acknowledgment” in America is without an “e” after the “g”. Avoid the stilted expression “one of us (R. B. G.) thanks ...”. Instead, try “R. B. G. thanks...”. Put sponsor acknowledgments in the unnumbered footnote on the first page.

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